Section No:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

B207A

Shaping Business Opportunities I

Mid-term Exam/Version B

Fall 2025-2026

19/November/2025

Number of Exam Pages: 10 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

1. Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2. Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3. This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4. This Mid-term exam will be marked out of 100 marks and is worth 30% of the total mark of the B207
5. Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except for graphs/sketches.
6. Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phone during the examination.
7. Any work crossed through will **NOT** be marked.
8. Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Question No.	Mark	Marker's Signature
Q1		
Q2		
Q3		
Q4		

Comments (FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY):

Total: ____ / 100

Final Ma

Reviewer's signature:

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QUESTION ONE (25 MARKS)

- *You should attempt to answer **ALL** questions in this section.*

Case Study:

The banking industry is a service-based business where customer satisfaction depends on trust, reliability, and the quality of interactions rather than physical products. Understanding the unique characteristics of services is essential to manage and market banking offerings effectively.

Q1 a. (15 Marks).

Services are different from tangible products. In this context, discuss the *four special characteristics of services* that make them unique in marketing. Provide an example for each characteristic.

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Q1 b. (10 Marks)

Using the *Banking industry* as an example, apply the *special characteristics of services*. For each characteristic, explain how it appears in the context of a Bank.

QUESTION TWO (25 MARKS):

Discuss two formal definitions of marketing from a professional and academic point of view. Additionally, elaborate on the various marketing functions, illustrating each with relevant examples.

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QUESTION THREE (25 MARKS):

Explain the concepts of globalisation, standardisation and customisation in marketing strategies and provide examples of how companies apply these approaches. Additionally, discuss the continuum from standardisation to adaptation with examples of suitable products for each.

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QUESTION FOUR (25 MARKS):

Discuss the concept of *marketing research*. In your answer, explain its key functions and its role in effective marketing decisions.

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